# ■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Thursday, August 06, 2026

## TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

## THE LIST (3 stories)

### ■ *Geno Smith seeing Jets training camp through totally different view — literally*

***The Angle:*** *Geno Smith seeing Jets training camp through totally different view — literally*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/06/sports/geno-smith-seeing-jets-camp-through-red-tinted-contact-lenses/

### ■■ *Trump-backed Tennessee congressman loses his own primary*

***The Angle:*** *A sitting House Republican who had Trump's endorsement just got knocked out in his own primary race—a rare upset that signals real fractures in the GOP coalition heading into the general election cycle.*

- Rep. **Andy Ogles** lost his Republican primary in **Tennessee's 5th District**
- Challenger **Charlie Hatcher** won with **53.2% of the vote**
- **Trump endorsed Ogles**—and it wasn't enough to save him

**The Upset Read**

- When Trump's endorsement can't save a sitting congressman in his own primary, what does that tell us about where Republican primary voters actually are right now?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/06/us-news/rep-andy-ogles-loses-tennessees-republican-primary-after-dramatic-district-reshape/

### ■ *Oh Cool, AI Is Inventing New Biological Viruses Now*

***The Angle:*** *Oh Cool, AI Is Inventing New Biological Viruses Now*

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/oh-cool-ai-is-inventing-new-biological-viruses-now-2000795623

## TRENDING TODAY

### ■ *Clippers star Kawhi Leonard caught in major salary-cap investigation*

***The Angle:*** *The NBA is digging into whether the LA Clippers used hidden endorsement deals to secretly pay Kawhi Leonard millions—essentially cheating the salary cap. It's the kind of behind-the-scenes financial maneuver that could reshape how teams operate.*

- **Kawhi Leonard** allegedly received a **$28 million endorsement deal** with **Aspiration Partners**
- The **Los Angeles Clippers** are under investigation for potentially circumventing salary-cap rules
- The **NBA's outside law firm, Wachtell, Lipton, Rosen & Katz**, is leading the probe
- Reports suggest additional undisclosed deals beyond the Aspiration Partners agreement may be involved

**The Salary-Cap Cheat Code**

- If the Clippers get caught cheating the system, should there be real penalties—or is this just how rich teams play the game?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/06/sports/clippers-kawhi-leonard-investigation-features-surprise-twist/

Backup options:

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### ■ *Joan Jett cancels tour after secret back surgery*

***The Angle:*** *The rock icon behind 'Bad Reputation' is sidelined by a broken back and surprise surgery—and at 67, she's being real about what recovery means. Fans are rallying, but it's a stark reminder even legends aren't invincible.*

- **Joan Jett**, 67, canceled upcoming concerts after undergoing surgery for a **broken back**
- The injury and surgical procedure were kept **secret** until the cancellation announcement
- Jett is known for her hit **'Bad Reputation'** and decades of relentless touring

**The Resilience Check**

- Have you ever had to step back from something you love because your body forced you to—and how did you handle that reality check?

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/08/06/celebrity-news/joan-jett-cancels-concerts-due-to-scary-injury-surgery/

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## LIFESTYLE CHAT

### ■ *NYC mosquito West Nile cases have doubled this summer*

***The Angle:*** *New York City is seeing a sharp spike in West Nile virus detected in mosquito populations—nearly double last year's numbers. With summer still in full swing, health officials are sounding the alarm on what travelers and residents need to know to stay safe.*

- **West Nile positive mosquito pools** in NYC have **nearly doubled** compared to last summer
- The spike comes as **NYC health officials** are actively monitoring mosquito populations across the city
- West Nile virus is spread through infected mosquito bites and can cause flu-like illness, fever, and in severe cases neurological complications

**The Watercooler Question**

- Are you actually changing your summer plans because of West Nile, or does this feel overblown?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/06/us-news/number-of-nyc-mosquito-pools-testing-positive-for-dangerous-west-nile-virus-has-doubled-since-last-year-health-officials/

Backup options:

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### ■ *Texas battling drug-resistant fungus spreading fast*

***The Angle:*** *Candida auris—a nasty fungal infection that laughs at antifungal drugs—is exploding across the country, and Texas is ground zero. It's mostly hitting hospitals, but the CDC is watching this close because it's getting harder to treat.*

- **Candida auris** is a yeast infection that's **resistant to antifungal drugs**, making it harder to treat than typical fungal infections
- **Texas leads the nation** in reported cases of the infection
- The infection **spreads in health care facilities** and can cause severe illness
- The fungus is **sometimes deadly** and poses particular risk to vulnerable patients

**The Wellness Reality Check**

- How many of you knew drug-resistant fungal infections were even a thing—and should we be worried about picking this up outside the hospital?

Houston Chronicle (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.houstonchronicle.com/news/houston-texas/trending/article/candida-auris-cases-texas-22375202.php

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## CLOSER: THROWBACK THURSDAY

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### ■ *Nordstrom Anniversary Sale shoe deals everyone's talking about*

***The Angle:*** *Nordstrom's annual Anniversary Sale is here, and the footwear section is packed with discounts on premium brands celebs actually wear. If you've been eyeing those pricey shoes, this is the window to grab them before inventory tanks.*

- **Nordstrom Anniversary Sale** is live with markdowns on **premium shoe brands**
- The sale features **celebrity-favorite footwear lines** at reduced prices
- Inventory is expected to move **quickly** as the sale progresses

**The Splurge Check**

- What's the one designer shoe you've been waiting to go on sale—and would you actually pull the trigger if it dropped 20-30% off?

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 69/90 (40 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> STRONG

URL: https://pagesix.com/style/best-nordstrom-anniversary-sale-shoe-deals-2026/

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## FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/3 this month; TECH TALK 1/2 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

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### ■ *OpenAI's Luxury Creator Trip Ignites Online Backlash*

***The Angle:*** *OpenAI flew content creators to an ultra-premium resort retreat while the company faces ongoing tensions over AI's impact on creators' livelihoods. The optics collision—and the swift deletion of celebratory posts—is sparking a wider debate about corporate PR, influencer credibility, and who really benefits from the AI boom.*

- OpenAI hosted an event called **"Summer Camp"** at **Auberge Collection's Wildflower Farms** in New York, described as a posh luxury retreat
- One creator initially posted about it being **"the dreamiest weekend"** before **deleting the clip** once backlash erupted online
- The trip comes amid ongoing creator concerns about **AI's impact on their livelihoods and content ownership**

**The Credibility Question**

- If you're a creator getting flown to a luxury resort by a company, can you actually criticize them—or does accepting the trip automatically make you look bought?

**ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN**

- **Step 1: The Optics Test** - Quick framing -> Hosts lay out the paradox: OpenAI courts creators for legitimacy, creators need the access and platform boost, but the payoff looks tone-deaf when AI is actively threatening creator jobs. Who loses credibility here?
- **Step 2: The Deletion Tell** - The real story -> Dig into why the creator yanked the post. Was it peer pressure, genuine regret, or damage control? What does that silence say about the influencer economy?
- **Step 3: The Listener Flip** - Audience engagement -> Ask callers: Would you accept the trip? Would you post about it? And if a creator you follow did—would you trust their take on AI going forward?

www.hollywoodreporter.com (Tier 3) | Score: 37/90 (12 fit + 4 source + 21 quality) -> BACKUP

URL: https://www.hollywoodreporter.com/lifestyle/lifestyle-news/openai-brand-trip-creators-backlash-wildflower-farms-1236666210/

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## ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

### ■ *'The Big Bang Theory' Star Melissa Rauch on Her Larger-Than-Life Surprise Role on 'Stuart Fails to Save the Universe'*

***The Angle:*** *'The Big Bang Theory' Star Melissa Rauch on Her Larger-Than-Life Surprise Role on 'Stuart Fails to Save the Universe'*

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/melissa-rauch-stuart-fails-to-save-the-universe-role-1236829612/

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### ■ *Spider-Man breaks box office records with historic Tuesday*

***The Angle:*** *Sony's new Spider-Man film just shattered the biggest Tuesday box office day ever recorded—this is the kind of cultural moment that tells you where audiences are spending their money right now, and it's a massive win for theaters coming off a rough couple of years.*

- **Spider-Man: Brand New Day** has set the record for the **biggest Tuesday in box office history**
- The film stars **Tom Holland**, **Zendaya**, and **Sadie Sink**
- The Sony Pictures feature continues to deliver record-breaking numbers throughout its launch weekend

**The Watercooler Question**

- Have you seen it yet, or are you waiting for the hype to die down before you catch it?

Hollywood Reporter (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: http://www.hollywoodreporter.com/movies/movie-news/spider-man-brand-new-day-box-office-biggest-tuesday-1236665110/

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### ■ *Bella Thorne and Zendaya Got Pitted Against Each Other During Disney Fame and Snuck Off Set to 'Hash It Out' After Things 'Got Pretty Bad' - Variety*

***The Angle:*** *Bella Thorne and Zendaya Got Pitted Against Each Other During Disney Fame and Snuck Off Set to 'Hash It Out' After Things 'Got Pretty Bad' - Variety*

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/zendaya-bella-thorne-feud-disney-pitted-against-each-other-1236828507/

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### ■ *BMW drivers furious over surprise Spider-Man ads in their cars*

***The Angle:*** *BMW owners just got a rude awakening: ads for Sony's latest Spider-Man flick popping up unbidden on their vehicle dashboards. It's the latest flashpoint in the ongoing tech-vs.-privacy standoff—your car is becoming a billboard, and people are not happy about it.*

- **BMW** launched a partnership with **Sony-Marvel** to push ads for **Spider-Man: Brand New Day** directly onto vehicle dashboards without clear owner consent
- Owners are flooding social media calling the move **"insanely dystopian"** and expressing outrage that their cars are now ad delivery systems
- The rollout was framed as a **"special surprise"** partnership, raising questions about whether drivers actually agreed to receive in-vehicle advertising

**The Boundary Breach**

- If your car started showing ads without asking—would you be furious, or does this feel like the inevitable future of connected vehicles?

**ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN**

- **Step 1: The Setup** - 30 seconds -> Hosts acknowledge the news and ask: How many listeners actually know what ads or data their cars are already collecting?
- **Step 2: The Spectrum** - 1 minute -> Host A takes the "it's the price of having tech" angle; Host B argues ownership rights—you paid for the car, you shouldn't be a captive audience

- **Step 3: The Phone Line** - 2–3 minutes -> Open lines: Have you caught ads or tracking in your car? Would you buy a vehicle if you knew this was coming? Do you even read the terms?
Hollywood Reporter (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: http://www.hollywoodreporter.com/movies/movie-news/bmw-spider-man-brand-new-day-ads-1236665172/

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### ■ *No.1 Sabalenka, No. 3 Pegula advance at National Bank Open*

***The Angle:*** *No.1 Sabalenka, No. 3 Pegula advance at National Bank Open*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/sports/tennis/no-1-sabalenka-no-3-pegula-advance-at-national-bank-open

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### ■ *Battling Norrie survives match point to oust de Minaur at Montreal*

***The Angle:*** *Battling Norrie survives match point to oust de Minaur at Montreal*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/sports/tennis/battling-norrie-survives-match-point-to-oust-de-minaur-at-montreal

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### ■ *Heat's on for UCLA football as Bob Chesney pushes players during camp*

***The Angle:*** *Heat's on for UCLA football as Bob Chesney pushes players during camp*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/06/sports/ucla-football-coach-bob-chesney-wants-team-tested-in-fire/

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### ■ *John Harbaugh could play Giants starters in preseason: 'We're a young team'*

***The Angle:*** *John Harbaugh could play Giants starters in preseason: 'We're a young team'*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/06/sports/john-harbaugh-leaning-toward-playing-giants-starters-in-preseason/

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### ■ *Carrie Underwood's SNF return has set social media in a frenzy*

***The Angle:*** *Carrie Underwood's SNF return has set social media in a frenzy*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/08/06/entertainment/carrie-underwoods-snf-return-has-set-social-media-in-a-frenzy/

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## FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Rebel Wilson cleared in Charlotte MacInnes' defamation case over 'bizarre' bathtub incident" (torontosun.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "'Am I Supposed to be a Comedian?': Donald Trump's Bizarre White House Correspondent's Dinner Speech Had Few Laughing" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-26)
- "Don Lemon and sexy Smurf joke make for bizarre scene, and more items from the column" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-29)
- "Phillies game forced into bizarre delay as Trea Turner's face lights up green" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-05)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 21 banked (+15 each when found)
- "The last time the sword-and-sandal epic truly conquered the Oscars was "Gladiator."" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-17)
- "Khloé Kardashian mourns late grandma MJ: 'Your love will forever be woven into who we are'" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-19)

- "'Scrubs' Revival Ups Ava Bunn to Series Regular, X Mayo and Joel Kim Booster Exit - Variety" (Variety (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-21)
- "The Beauty Finds I'm Buying During Nordstrom's Anniversary Sale - The Cut" (The Cut (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-21)
- "'La La Land' 10th Anniversary Poster Finally Corrects Ryan Gosling's Flat Hand" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-21)
- "'Harry Potter' Back to Hogwarts 2026 Celebrations Feature 'Sorcerer's Stone' 25th Anniversary Rerelease, New Glimpses of HBO Series" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Apple Testing 7-Inch Display for Largest 20th Anniversary iPhone Model - MacRumors" (MacRumors (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-22)
- "LISTEN: Reba McEntire Revels in 50 Years of Making Music and Season 3 of NBC's 'Happy's Place'" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Nordstrom's Anniversary Sale Is a Goldmine of Jewelry Markdowns — Here Are the 23 Standouts" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Here's How Louis Tomlinson Really Feels About These One Direction Songs on Band's 16-Year Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-07-24)
- "Guillermo del Toro said 'Absolutely No Goddamn AI' in 'Pan's Labyrinth' 3D Re-Release: 'We're Protecting a Lineage of Art'" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-24)
- "Shop Oprah's 'favorites' at the Nordstrom Anniversary Sale, from 'ultra-flattering' pants to skin care staples" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-24)
- "'Star Trek: Starfleet Academy' Has a Troublemaking New Alien Arriving in Season 2 - Gizmodo" (Gizmodo.com (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-26)
- "Apple TV's Neuromancer poster raises questions about its adaptation of an 'unfilmable' novel - Creative Bloq" (Creative Bloq (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-27)
- "'Bold Voice of Contemporary Horror' Comic-Con Panelists Predict the Four Biggest Upcoming Trends in Genre Filmmaking" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-27)
- "'Everybody Loves Raymond' star Patricia Heaton backs calls to ban Mayor Zohran Mamdani from 9/11 anniversary in NYC https://t.co/UCpYAdZR5o " (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-07-29)
- "Boy George Drops Out of 'Jesus Christ Superstar' After Pro-Israel Song Release - Rolling Stone" (Rolling Stone (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-31)
- "'Sunday in the Park with George' Producers Confirm Summer 2027 Show Will Go On 'As Planned' After Ariana Grande Exits" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-03)
- "Nordstrom Anniversary Sale Ends Soon — 27 Steals From Hollywood's Most-Loved Labels" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-03)
- "Rosie O'Donnell's 'The View' reunion comments spark alumni meltdown over invites" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-08-04)
- "Anniversary of capybaras escaping High Park inspires video game - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-05)

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## SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/upliftingnews (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/nottheonion (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/technology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/futurology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/science (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/canada (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- www.cbc.ca (fetch failed)
- @WomenBeingAwful (fetch failed)
- @NYPost (fetch failed)
- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)
- @CTVNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (fetch failed)
- @Billboard (fetch failed)
- @Variety (fetch failed)

- 16 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-08-06 11:38 PM